

Target Workshops — Submission Shortlist (workshop held on/before December 2026)

Compiled: 2026-05-30 (via live web search). **Scope (per your instruction): workshops only** — no main-track submissions — within the **ICML / NeurIPS / ICLR** families. **Hard constraint:** the **workshop must be held on or before December 2026** (not just the deadline). **Paper:** *Portable Fused GPU Kernels for Sensitive Protein Homology Search* (see [01-research-paper-plan.md](#)).

Bottom line

After applying both filters (workshops only **and** held $\leq$ Dec 2026, with deadlines still open as of 30 May 2026), the field collapses to **one viable family**:

→ NeurIPS 2026 workshops (held **11–13 December 2026**; paper deadlines ~late Aug 2026).

Everything else is eliminated:

- **ICML 2026 workshops** are *held* in time (10–11 Jul 2026) but their **paper deadlines have already passed** (the flagship bio workshop, GenBio, closed **8 May 2026**; ICML workshops notify authors by ~mid/late May).
- **ICLR 2026 workshops** were held **April 2026** — already in the past.
- **ICLR 2027 workshops** are held in **2027** — after your December 2026 cutoff (deadlines ~Feb 2027 anyway).

So: aim at the **NeurIPS 2026 workshops**, and within them, **MLSB** is your best topical home.



Viable: NeurIPS 2026 workshops

Umbrella facts (from the official Call for Workshops):

Item	Date
Workshop line-up announced to organizers	11 Jul 2026 (individual CFPs appear shortly after)
NeurIPS-suggested paper submission date	~29 Aug 2026 (AoE) — each workshop sets its own, typically late Aug–mid Sep
Mandatory accept/reject notification	29 Sep 2026 (AoE)
Workshop days	11–13 Dec 2026 (Sydney 11–12; Paris & Atlanta 12–13)

Official: [NeurIPS 2026 Call for Workshops](#) · [NeurIPS 2026 Dates](#)



The **2026 editions of the specific workshops below are not announced yet** (they can't be, until the 11 Jul 2026 line-up). The rows give the recurring series, why it fits, and an **estimated** deadline from

the 2025 edition + the NeurIPS-suggested 29 Aug date. **Re-check each site in mid-to-late July 2026** for the confirmed CFP.

Recommended workshops (in priority order for this paper)

#	Workshop (series)	Why it fits your paper	Est. 2026 deadline	Fit	Official site
1	MLSB — Machine Learning in Structural Biology	Your kernels accelerate the MSA-generation substrate behind AlphaFold/ColabFold and the Foldseek structural search you benchmark — directly in MLSB's scope (structure prediction, protein search, biomolecular methods). 6th edition expected at NeurIPS 2026.	~late Aug / early Sep 2026	 Strongest	mlsb.io
2	AI for Science	Broad "compute/AI enabling scientific discovery"; your speed/cost/energy gains that unlock larger sensitive searches fit its tools-for-science framing. Runs at NeurIPS most years.	~late Aug / early Sep 2026	 Good	ai4sciencecommunity.github.io
3	ML for Systems	Systems/GPU-kernel angle (fusion, roofline, cross-vendor portability). Caveat: its theme is <i>using ML to improve computer systems</i> (learned heuristics), whereas you hand-write Triton kernels for a bio workload — a thematic stretch despite the systems flavour. 2025 deadline was 22 Aug 2025.	~late Aug 2026	 Borderline	mlforsystems.org · CFP

When the 11 Jul 2026 line-up drops, also scan it for any new **"efficient ML / systems"** or **"AI for (accelerated) science"** workshop — these recur under varying names and any of them would suit the

systems half of the paper.

✗ Ruled out (and exactly why)

Venue	Held	Deadline	Why excluded
ICML 2026 workshops (GenBio, AI for Science, life-sciences FM, efficiency workshops, ...)	10–11 Jul 2026  in time	Passed — GenBio closed 8 May 2026 ; ICML workshops notify by ~15–25 May	Deadlines already passed as of 30 May 2026
ICLR 2026 workshops	Apr 2026 (Rio)	Feb 2026	Workshop already happened
ICLR 2027 workshops	~2027 (TBA)	~Feb 2027 (est.)	Held after Dec 2026 cutoff; deadline also after cutoff
ICML 2027 / NeurIPS 2027 workshops	2027	2027	Held after Dec 2026

Evidence for the ICML exclusion: GenBio ICML 2026 (the flagship Generative/Agentic-AI-for-Biology workshop) lists submission **8 May 2026**, notification **25 May 2026**, workshop **10 Jul 2026** — i.e., the most relevant ICML bio workshop closed three weeks before today. The full ICML 2026 line-up (44 workshops, incl. "AI for Science: AI Scientists", "future of AI for biology", "Multi-modal Foundation Models ... for Life Sciences", several efficiency/adaptive-inference workshops) is announced [here](#), but all operate on the same ~early-May deadline cycle.

Why a workshop is the right move here (and the journal still works)

- **Non-archival.** NeurIPS workshops have no formal proceedings, so a workshop paper **does not block the full *Bioinformatics* journal submission** in [01-research-paper-plan.md](#). You get early visibility *and* the journal.
- **Right length.** Workshops want ~4–9 pages (NeurIPS style files) — a natural condensation of the plan: lead with **H1 (NVIDIA bit-exact parity) + H2 (first sensitive GPU filter on AMD MI300X)**; keep the full benchmark suite for the journal.
- **Binding milestone.** To make the ~**29 Aug 2026** deadline you need Phases 0–1 (NVIDIA filter at bit-exact parity) **and** Phase 4a (the AMD MI300X port — your headline) **measured by ~mid-August 2026**. Everything else (fusion ablations, SWG, end-to-end ColabFold/Foldseek) can follow for the journal version.

Action calendar

When	Action
Now → mid-Aug 2026	Run Phases 0–1 + 4a on the cluster → H1 (parity) + H2 (AMD port).

When	Action
11 Jul 2026	NeurIPS 2026 workshop line-up announced. Confirm MLSB / AI4Science / ML-for-Systems 2026 CFPs + exact deadlines + page limits.
~29 Aug 2026	Submit 4–9p workshop paper to MLSB @ NeurIPS 2026 (primary); optionally also AI for Science.
29 Sep 2026	Workshop accept/reject notifications (NeurIPS mandatory date).
11–13 Dec 2026	Present at NeurIPS 2026 workshop (Sydney / Paris / Atlanta).
Parallel	Submit the full paper to <i>Bioinformatics</i> (unaffected by non-archival workshop acceptance).

Sources (official / primary)

- NeurIPS 2026 Call for Workshops — <https://neurips.cc/Conferences/2026/CallForWorkshops>
- NeurIPS 2026 Dates & Deadlines — <https://neurips.cc/Conferences/2026/Dates>
- ICML 2026 Workshops announcement (44 workshops) — <https://blog.icml.cc/2026/04/06/announcing-the-icml-2026-workshops-and-affinity-workshops/>
- ICML 2026 workshop list (virtual) — <https://icml.cc/virtual/2026/events/workshop>
- GenBio @ ICML 2026 (evidence ICML bio workshops are closed: deadline 8 May 2026) — <https://genbio-workshop.github.io/2026/>
- MLSB (Machine Learning in Structural Biology) — <https://www.mlsb.io/>
- AI for Science workshop series — <https://ai4sciencecommunity.github.io/>
- ML for Systems workshop — <http://mlforsystems.org/> · CFP — http://mlforsystems.org/call_for_papers.html
- ICLR Future Meetings (confirms no official ICLR 2027 listing yet) — <https://iclr.cc/Conferences/FutureMeetings>

Outside the three families you named, the most topically ideal workshop-style options held within 2026 would be domain venues like **MLCB (Machine Learning in Computational Biology, ~Nov–Dec 2026)** or the **MLSys** workshop track — say the word and I'll search those too.